which has considerable refinery and distribution capacity, for privatization, can oil refining and marketing be called strategic? When power-sector generation is primarily taking place in the renewable sector and the private sector, how can power generation be strategic? Is telecom strategic enough to retain MTNL and BSNL in the public sector when the proportion of subscribers they serve is less than 10 per cent?

There is no sector in which CPSEs are operating that is strategic; no CPSE that is strategic; and no objective criterion that can be evolved to define any sector or CPSE as strategic. It leads nowhere. Of course, if you do not want to privatize a particular CPSE, you can always take the shelter of calling it strategic. If you don’t want to privatize, don’t do it but do not take shelter under the excuse of calling any sector or CPSE strategic.